2012 Canadian Community Health Survey
Dummy File for Remote Access to the Master File

November 2013

Notice

The dummy files should not be used for purposes other than to develop and test the computer programs that are to be submitted by remote access. The dummy files contain modified data and must never be used for analytical purposes.

1. Background and Overview

The Canadian Community Health Survey (CCHS) is a cross-sectional survey that collects information related to health status, health care utilization and health determinants for the Canadian population. It is a large sample, general population health survey, designed to provide reliable estimates at the health region level. Access to the data is usually made through Research Data Centers (RDCs) or by using the Public Use Micro-data File (PUMF).

In some instances where access to Research Data Centers is not feasible and the public use micro-data files do not provide enough information, researchers can apply for remote access. Once their project is approved, researchers are provided with synthetic data (the Dummy file) from which they develop and test their computer programs (in SAS or SPSS), and then transmit them to the Population Health Surveys Data Access Unit (DAU) via a dedicated e-mail address. The programs are run on the secure data servers by DAU staff, who also vet the outputs for disclosure issues, and return the vetted outputs to the user via e-mail. Remote access to the data is offered free of charge, but is restricted to projects with demonstrated needs. For more information on remote access, contact the DAU staff at hd-ds@statcan.gc.ca.

For the 2012 CCHS, the following dummy data files were created:

- **Full sample file:** File with respondents and all variables from core, theme and optional modules; 18,387 records.

While certain administrative variables (which are of no analytical interest) have been recoded to “blank”, the dummy file simulates the master files perfectly. It contains the same variables and has the same record layout. The data values, however, have been modified in order to protect the confidentiality of respondents. This includes randomly generating the postal codes and all related geographical information within health regions. Except by chance, the postal codes are not those from the sample. Also note that the number of records has been reduced by more than 60% compared to what is available in master versions of these files.

Corresponding dummy bootstrap weights files were also created for each of these files. The CD-ROM includes links to SAS and SPSS macro programs (Bootvar) for calculating the variance of estimates using these bootstrap

weights but any statistical package able to apply bootstrap weights or Balanced Repeated Replication (BRR) weights can be used.

The CD-ROM also contains peripheral SAS and SPSS layout statement files, as well as the technical and methodological documentation usually accompanying the master files. Please refer to Section 3 of the present document for the complete list of files on this CD-ROM.

2. Creation of the dummy file

2.1 Classes of Variables

All records are first classified by age and sex. The purpose for this is to create classes of records having the same questionnaire flow so that, after random permutation of the data within the classes, each dummy record contains data respecting a certain internal consistency.

2.2 Sampling and Restrictions of Variable Values

As an additional measure of preserving data confidentiality in the master files, the dummy files are created by sub-sampling the master file records. Also, quantitative variables are top-coded and bottom-coded. Variables considered as sensitive or without analytical value are recoded to "blank" (see section 2.4). All of these modifications mean that we do not necessarily find all the possible categories for each variable on the dummy file. In addition, the postal codes and all related geographical information were randomly selected from all possible postal codes within health regions. Except by chance, the postal codes are not those from the sample. To obtain complete information on a specific variable, users are asked to consult the master files' documentation. Finally, all the weight variables have been post-stratified according to the same methods used to post-stratify the master file weights. However, it should be noted that the weights remain "dummy" weights. Other details related to the creation of this file are not available because they would disclose too much information on the method used for creating the dummy data, hence putting confidentiality at risk.

2.3 Blocks of variables

The third step consists of creating blocks of variables. Dummy records are produced by randomly swapping blocks of variables for the records in the same class. At first, elementary blocks of variables are grouped following the various modules of the questionnaire. Blocks do not always correspond to modules of the questionnaire, however, as some modules are split differently. If the content of the elementary block depends on the answers obtained in a previous block, the respective elementary block is amalgamated with the other one to preserve the internal consistency of the records.

2.4 Recode Variables to "blank"

The following variables are recoded to "blank" during the creation of the dummy files:

PERSONID	SAM_TYP	SAM_CP	SAMDSHR	SAMDLNK	ADM_STA
ADM_PRX	ADM_YOI	ADM_MOI	ADM_DOI	ADM_N09	ADM_N10
ADM_N11	ADM_LHH	ADM_N12	DHH_YOB	DHH_MOB	DHH_DOB

3. Content of CD-ROM

LISEZ_MOI.PDF	French documentation about remote-access, creation of the dummy file and contents of the CD-ROM
READ_ME.PDF	English documentation about remote-access, creation of the dummy file and contents of the CD-ROM

Dummy file:

DATA\

HS.TXT	2012 CCHS dummy file for the full sample (18,387 records)

Record Layouts, Statements:

LAYOUT\

HS_fmt.sas	SAS Format Statement.
HS_i.sas	SAS Infile and Input Statements.
HS_lbe.sas	SAS Label Statement in English.
HS_lbf.sas	SAS Label Statement in French.
HS_pfe.sas	SAS Proc Format Statement in English.
HS_pff.sas	SAS Proc Format Statement in French.
HS_i.sps	SPSS Infile Statement.
HSmiss.sps	SPSS Missing Values Statement.
HSvale.sps	SPSS Value Labels Statement in English.
HSvalf.sps	SPSS Value Labels Statement in French.
HSvare.sps	SPSS Variable Labels Statement in English.
HSvarf.sps	SPSS Variable Labels Statement in French.
readmstr.sas	Program to read, label and format the ASCII format data file into SAS format.
readmstr.sps	Program to read, label and format the ASCII format data file into SPSS format.

Documentation:

DOC\

CCHS_2012_Alphabetic_Index.pdf	Alphabetic Index in English.
CCHS_2012_Data_Dictionary(rounded_frequencies).pdf	Data Dictionary in English.
CCHS_2012_Derived_Variables_Documentation.pdf	Derived Variable Documentation in English.
CCHS_2012_Questionnaire.pdf	Questionnaire in English.
CCHS_2012_Record_Layout.pdf	Record Layout in English.
CCHS_2012_Topical_Index.pdf	Topical Index in English.
CCHS_2012_2011-2012_User_Guide.pdf	User Guide in English.
ESCC_2012_Cliché_Enregistrement.pdf	Record Layout in French.

ESCC_2012_Dictionnaire_de_données(fréquences_arrondies).pdf	Data Dictionary in French.
ESCC_2012_2011-2012_Guide_utilisateur.pdf	User Guide in French.
ESCC_2012_Questionnaire.pdf	Questionnaire in French.
ESCC_2012_Table_Alphabétique.pdf	Alphabetic Index in French.
ESCC_2012_Index_des_variables_par_sujet.pdf	Topical Index in French
ESCC_2012_Variables_Dérivées.pdf	Derived Variable Documentation in French.

Files related to bootstrap weights for variance calculation:

BOOTSTRP\

DATA\

B5.TXT	Bootstrap weights for the full sample in ASCII format.
B5.SAS	Bootstrap weights for the full sample in SAS format.

LAYOUT\

B5_i.sas	SAS Record Layout for the bootstrap weights file B5.TXT.
B5_i.sps	SPSS Record Layout for the bootstrap weights file B5.TXT.

BOOTVAR\

BOOTSTRAP_E.pdf	Download location for Bootvar in English.
BOOTSTRAP_F.pdf	Download location for Bootvar in French.